

MILAN-CORTINA

OLYMPICS



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AFTER THE MOST widespread Games in history, athletes march in the closing ceremony at Verona Olympic Arena. These Olympics had an eventful final day, with the U.S. men’s hockey team grabbing the last gold with a 2-1 overtime win over Canada. **MORE COVERAGE, D1**

L.A. now waits for the flame to return

In just over two years, the U.S. will host its first Summer Olympics since 1996.

BY THUC NHI NGUYEN

VERONA, Italy — In fair Verona, L.A., unofficially, takes the torch.

While the Olympic flag passed from Italy to France at Sunday’s closing ceremony, handing off the Winter Games from Milan-Cortina to the French Alps, the flame will burn next in L.A.

In just over two years, the United States will host the country’s first Summer Games since 1996, welcoming an Olympic movement that is surging in popularity but unsteady in a changing world, as the Games return to Los Angeles for the third time.

The Milan-Cortina Olympics are expected to rake in record TV numbers for NBC. They already produced the most-watched women’s hockey game on record as an average of 5.3 million viewers took in the United States’ thrilling overtime win over Canada. The rivalry game contributed to the largest weekday audience for a Winter Games since 2014 with an average of 26.7 million viewers who also watched U.S. star Alysa Liu win the country’s first Olympic gold medal for women’s singles figure skating in 24 years.

The smiling 20-year-old with horizontal stripes in her hair became a sensation in Milan just as 41-year-old mother of two Elana Meyers Taylor did in Cortina d’Ampezzo after the five-time Olympian won her first gold medal in bobsled, jumping into the arms of her nanny and, through tears, signing to her deaf children, “Mommy won.”

No matter protests, politics or planning hurdles, the Olympics sought to remain a stage for those athletes to shine.

“You showed us what excellence, respect and friendship [See Games, A7]

California Democrats unite against Trump, differ on vision for state

BY NICOLE NIXON AND SEEMA MEHTA
REPORTING FROM SAN FRANCISCO

While united against a common political enemy in the White House, the California Democratic Party remains deeply divided over how to address the state’s affordability crisis and who is best suited to lead the state in this turbulent era of President Trump.

Those fractures revealed themselves during the party’s annual convention in California’s liberal epicenter, San Francisco, where a slate of Democrats running to succeed Gov. Gavin Newsom pitched very different visions for the state.

Former Orange County Rep. Katie Porter and wealthy financier Tom Steyer were among the top candidates who swung left, with Porter vowing to enact free child care and tuition-free

college and Steyer backing a proposed new tax on billionaires. Both candidates also support universal health-care.

San Jose Mayor Matt Mahan, the newest major candidate to enter the race, hewed toward partisan middle ground, chastising leaders in Sacramento for allowing the state budget to balloon without tangible improvements to housing affordability, homelessness and public schools.

Rep. Eric Swalwell (D-Dublin), a vociferous critic and constant target of the Trump administration, emerged from the convention with the greatest momentum after receiving the most votes for the California Democratic Party’s endorsement,

with 24% of delegates backing him.

“The next governor has two jobs: one, to keep Donald Trump and ICE out of our streets and out of our lives, and two, to lower your costs on health-care, on housing, on utilities,” Swalwell said. “Californians need a fighter and protector, and for the last 10 years, I’ve gone on offense against the worst president ever.”

Still, none of the top Democrats running for governor received the 60% vote needed to capture the endorsement, indicating just how uncertain the race remains just months from the June primary.

Betty Yee, a former state controller and party vice chair, placed second in [See Convention, A8]



MYUNG J. CHUN Los Angeles Times

ACTIVISTS said they pursued “a systemic approach” and not a “blame game.”

Altadena marks a big step in fight for post-fire justice

BY GRACE TOOHEY

The Los Angeles fire-storm of January 2025 was a double disaster, burning thousands of homes and taking dozens of lives across Pacific Palisades and Altadena.

But over the last year, much of the national conversation has drifted toward Pacific Palisades and away from Altadena — despite glaring shortcomings in both fires that deserve scrutiny and accountability.

Concern and anger about issues from the Palisades

fire have been amplified by celebrity victims and well-connected critics of Los Angeles City Hall, their plight swept up in the nation’s highly polarized politics. In the fall, Republican members of Congress launched an investigation into the L.A. fires, but the probe has so far only focused on the Palisades fire. More recently, as the Trump administration pushed for expedited rebuilding, officials met only with victims from the Palisades.

Many in west Altadena have been left with a frustrating — but familiar — feel-

ing: like they are being overlooked.

“If you just dropped in from another planet and you didn’t know and you started looking at L.A. wildfires ... you would think the only area that was hit was Pacific Palisades,” said Earl Ofari Hutchinson, president of the Los Angeles Urban Policy Roundtable. “West Altadena has gotten lost in the shuffle.”

The historically Black community, made up primarily of working-class families, didn’t receive evacuation alerts until the fire had [See Altadena, A7]

Man who breached Mar-a-Lago is slain

The 21-year-old was holding a shotgun and fuel can, authorities say. Trump was away.

BY JENNY JARVIE

An armed man was shot and killed Sunday morning after he entered the secure perimeter of President Trump’s private Florida residence and resort, Mar-a-Lago, and was confronted by U.S. Secret Service agents and a Palm Beach County sheriff’s deputy.

The man killed was identified by investigators as 21-year-old Austin Tucker Martin from North Carolina, according to a law enforcement source familiar with the investigation. Martin had been reported missing by his family a few days prior.

Mexican military kills top drug lord

‘El Mencho,’ known for his brutality, was among world’s most wanted cartel leaders.

BY PATRICK J. McDONNELL, KATE LINTHICUM AND KEEGAN HAMILTON

MEXICO CITY — Mexican authorities have killed one of the world’s most wanted drug traffickers, Nemesio Rubén Oseguera Cervantes, known as “El Mencho,” founder and leader of the notorious Jalisco New Generation cartel, which controls drug smuggling, extortion, fuel theft and other rackets throughout Mexico.

Oseguera, believed to be 59, suffered fatal wounds during a Sunday morning military assault in the town of Tapalpa in Jalisco state, according to the Mexican Defense Ministry. He died while being airlifted to Mexico City for medical treatment along with other cartel associates injured in the raid, the military said.

Six other cartel operatives were also killed in the operation, the military said, and three soldiers were injured.

The drug kingpin’s killing also triggered violence. As the news spread, apparent supporters of the late cartel boss set fire to vehicles and blocked roads across western Mexico, prompting fears of escalating chaos in coming days and weeks.

Oseguera’s death is the most significant takedown of a Mexican capo since the 2016 capture of Joaquín “El Chapo” Guzmán, the former head of the Sinaloa cartel. El Chapo was extradited to the United States and is serving a life sentence in a U.S. prison.

The operation comes as [See Drug lord, A4]

Tipping, its racist past and online furor

BY SUHAUNA HUSSAIN

Geoff Davis doesn’t want his employees to have to rely on tips.

The acclaimed chef, who worked in restaurants and cocktail bars across the Bay Area and wine country before opening the Oakland soul food eatery Burdell, points out on customers’ receipts that tipping culture in the United States has a racist history — rooted in underpaid service jobs relegated to formerly enslaved Black workers.

Instead of tips, his restaurant adds a 20% service fee to the bill. It takes the guesswork and luck out of the equation, Davis said, and helps to stabilize wages across dining rooms and kitchens — where servers often receive tips but cooks and dishwashers do not — and helps offset the cost of healthcare benefits offered to full-time employees.

The service charge is not an out-of-the-ordinary practice, and is common among some upscale restaurants. And yet, Davis’ restaurant [See Tipping, A8]

ICE detention sites kept secret

Amid resistance, at least 20 communities with large warehouses are part of targeted facility expansion. **NATION, A5**

Disappearances that captivate

From Amelia Earhart to Nancy Guthrie, missing notables leave us unsettled, Patt Morrison writes. **CALIFORNIA, B3**

‘Bookfluencers’ may be the future

A publishing startup enlists online influencers as a strategy to thrive in social media era. **ENTERTAINMENT, E1**

Weather
Partly sunny and warm.
L.A. Basin: 81/53. **B6**

